

Universal Human Values – II (HS201)

Module 1: Basic Human Aspiration and Its Fulfilment
Question Sheet — Prepared from class notes, teacher's manual & assignment

Note on syllabus: No official syllabus document was provided. This question sheet has been compiled directly from the uploaded Module 1 notes (UHV2_Module1_Notes.docx), the Teachers' Manual (Module-1_UHV-II_notes.pdf — Lectures 1–6), and the Module 1 Assignment, so that every topic taught in these materials is covered. Section A carries 2 marks per question (short answer) and Section B carries 7 marks per question (long/descriptive answer).

SECTION A — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks Each)

Basic aspiration

Q1. What is the basic aspiration of every human being?

Answer:

Every human being aspires for continuous happiness and prosperity. Happiness is a state of being content and in harmony within, while prosperity is having more than the required physical facility. This aspiration is universal — the same for all people, at all times and in all places.

Value Education vs Skill Development

Q2. Distinguish between Value Education (VE) and Skill Development (SD).

Answer:

Value Education addresses 'what to do' — it develops clarity about our aspirations and what is truly valuable in life. Skill Development addresses 'how to do' — it develops the competence (science, technology, management, etc.) needed to fulfil those aspirations. Priority is given to values first, then skills, since skills only provide means, not the understanding of what is worth achieving.

Guidelines of VE

Q3. List the five guidelines that content of Value Education must satisfy.

Answer:

Value Education must be: (1) Universal — applicable to all human beings, everywhere, for all time; (2) Rational — based on reasoning, not dogma; (3) Natural and Verifiable — naturally acceptable and experientially checkable; (4) All-Encompassing — covering all dimensions and levels of life; and (5) Leading to Harmony — within the individual, among people, and with nature.

Value of an entity

Q4. What is meant by the 'value' of an entity? Give an example.

Answer:

The value of an entity is its participation in the larger order of which it is a part. For example, a piece of chalk is a unit and the classroom is its larger order; the chalk's value lies in being used to write on the blackboard for the desired functioning of the classroom.

Self-exploration

Q5. What is Self-exploration?

Answer:

Self-exploration is the process of seeing reality on one's own right through investigation, observation and analysis, rather than accepting things because someone else says so. It is essentially a dialogue — first between the teacher and student, and finally within one's own Self.

Dialogue within

Q6. Explain the 'dialogue within' as described in Self-exploration.

Answer:

The dialogue within is between 'what I am' (my current desires, thoughts and expectations) and 'what is naturally acceptable to me' (my natural acceptance/intention). When the two are in harmony, we feel happy; when they are in contradiction, we feel unhappy.

Content for self-exploration

Q7. What are the two parts of the content for self-exploration?

Answer:

The content for self-exploration has two sub-parts: (a) Desire — what is our basic aspiration, and (b) Programme — what is the way to fulfil that basic aspiration. Answering these two questions answers practically all our questions in life.

Process of self-exploration

Q8. Briefly describe the two-step process of self-exploration.

Answer:

First, we verify a given proposal on our own right by checking it against our natural acceptance. Second, we carry out experiential validation by living according to it — checking whether our behaviour with human beings leads to mutual happiness, and our work with nature leads to mutual prosperity.

Natural acceptance

Q9. List any four characteristics of Natural Acceptance.

Answer:

Natural acceptance does not change with time, does not change with place, does not change with the individual, is uncorrupted by likes/dislikes or beliefs, is innate (not created), and is definite — any four of these may be stated.

Happiness & Unhappiness defined

Q10. Define Happiness and Unhappiness in terms of harmony.

Answer:

Happiness is to be in a state of harmony or synergy — being in a state/situation that is naturally acceptable to us. Unhappiness is being forced to be in a state of disharmony or contradiction — a state/situation that is not naturally acceptable to us.

Priority order

Q11. What is the correct priority order among Right Understanding, Relationship and Physical Facility?

Answer:

Right understanding is the first priority, fulfilment in relationship with human beings is the second priority, and ensuring physical facility with the rest of nature is the third priority. All three are necessary, but one cannot substitute for another.

Animal vs Human consciousness

Q12. Differentiate between Animal Consciousness and Human Consciousness.

Answer:

In Animal Consciousness, one lives mainly for physical facility, without ensuring right understanding and relationship, leading to unhappiness and deprivation. In Human Consciousness, one lives with right understanding, fulfilling relationship, and physical facility in correct priority, leading to mutual happiness and mutual prosperity.

Education-Sanskar

Q13. What is the role of Education-Sanskar?

Answer:

Education develops right understanding (a holistic perspective) in every child, while Sanskar is the commitment, preparation and practice of living by that understanding, including learning appropriate skills and technology. Together they enable transformation to human consciousness.

Physical facility inadequate

Q14. Why is physical facility alone not adequate for human beings, though it is adequate for animals?

Answer:

For animals, physical facility is both necessary and largely adequate for their fulfilment. For human beings, physical facility is necessary but not adequate by itself, because humans also need right understanding and fulfilling relationships to be truly happy and prosperous.

Excitement vs Happiness

Q15. What is 'excitement' and how does it differ from real happiness?

Answer:

Excitement is the momentary, short-lived pleasure obtained from favourable sensations (physical facility) or favourable feelings from others; it is not sustainable. Real happiness is a continuous, harmonious state within, independent of external sensation or others' approval.

Prosperity defined

Q16. Define Prosperity as per Universal Human Values.

Answer:

Prosperity is the feeling of having more than the required physical facility. It requires (1) right assessment of the need for physical facility and its quantity, and (2) ensuring availability/production of more than that required quantity.

Four levels of living

Q17. Name the four levels at which the programme for continuity of happiness must be ensured.

Answer:

The programme for continuity of happiness must be ensured at four levels: (1) the individual human being, (2) the family, (3) society, and (4) nature/existence — by understanding and living in harmony at each level.

SECTION B — Long/Descriptive Answer Questions (7 Marks Each)

Need for Value Education

Q1. Explain the need for Value Education in the present education system. Discuss the relationship between values and skills.

Answer:

Every human being aspires for a happy and fulfilling life, and this raises two questions: 'What is my aspiration?' (what to do) and 'How to fulfil it?' (how to do). Understanding what is truly valuable for a human being — our aspirations and the goal of a fulfilling life — is the value domain, addressed by Value Education (VE). Learning the skills, technology and competence to actualise these aspirations is the skill domain, addressed by Skill Development (SD).

Both values and skills are essential and complementary: the priority is first to understand 'what to do' (values) and then to develop 'how to do it' (skills), and finally to check whether this actually results in a fulfilling life. However, the present education system has become heavily skill-biased, emphasising science and technology without a base of values. Skills only provide the means to achieve what is considered valuable; they cannot, by themselves, tell us what is truly valuable. The result of this skill-biased approach is visible in serious crises at the individual, societal and environmental levels — stress, broken relationships, corruption and environmental damage.

Therefore, Value Education is a crucial missing link in present-day education. Its prime need is to help us understand our aspirations, discover what is truly valuable in life, and work out a programme for its fulfilment — so that education leads not just to skilled individuals, but to happy, humane and responsible human beings.

Guidelines for VE

Q2. Explain, with examples, the five guidelines that qualify content as genuine Value Education.

Answer:

For any content to qualify as Value Education, it must satisfy five guidelines:

- 1. Universal:** It must apply to all human beings, for all time and all places, regardless of sect, creed, nationality or gender — values do not change from person to person.
- 2. Rational:** It must appeal to reasoning rather than dogma or blind belief; it must be open to questioning and discussion, not merely a set of sermons or do's and don'ts.
- 3. Natural and Verifiable:** It must be naturally acceptable to human beings, with provision in nature for its fulfilment, and it must be experientially verifiable in one's own life rather than based on assumption.
- 4. All-Encompassing:** It must cover all dimensions of human life — thought, behaviour, work and understanding — and all levels — individual, family, society and nature/existence.
- 5. Leading to Harmony:** It must ultimately promote harmony within the individual, among human beings, and with the entire nature.

For instance, the proposal that 'human beings desire continuous happiness and prosperity' is universal (true for everyone), rational (can be examined logically), verifiable (each person can check it in their own experience), all-encompassing (covers self, relationships and physical facility), and leads to harmony when properly understood and lived. Content that fails any of these tests — such as beliefs that vary by culture or cannot be personally verified — does not qualify as Value Education.

Q3. Explain Self-exploration as the process of Value Education. Describe the dialogue within and the two-part verification process.

Answer:

Human values are potentially present in every human being as a 'natural acceptance'; the task is only to discover or become aware of them. For this reason, the process of Value Education is Self-exploration — a process of seeing reality through one's own investigation, observation and analysis — rather than being told what is right through sermons or instructions.

Self-exploration takes the form of a dialogue. It begins as a dialogue between teacher and student, in which proposals are presented for the student to explore, and eventually becomes a dialogue within the student's own Self — between 'what I am' (my current desires, thoughts, expectations and way of deciding) and 'what is naturally acceptable to me' (my natural acceptance, or what I really want to be). When these two are in harmony, we experience happiness; when they are in contradiction, we experience unhappiness.

The process of self-exploration itself has two parts. First is verification: whatever is presented is treated only as a proposal, not assumed to be true or false, and is checked against one's own natural acceptance. Second is experiential validation: living according to the proposal to see its actual outcome — in behaviour with other human beings, checking whether it leads to mutual happiness, and in work with the rest of nature, checking whether it leads to mutual prosperity. A proposal that passes both verification and experiential validation is recognised as right understanding, since it is assuring, satisfying, and universal — holding true for all time, all places and every individual.

Q4. 'Continuous happiness and prosperity are the basic aspirations of every human being.' Explain this statement and the priority among right understanding, relationship and physical facility.

Answer:

When we ask ourselves whether we want to be happy, whether we want to be prosperous, and whether we want this happiness and prosperity to continue, the answer is always an affirmative yes. This shows that continuity of happiness and prosperity is the natural, basic aspiration of every human being.

In practice, however, there is a gap between this aspiration and our actual state, because most effort is directed only towards accumulating physical facility, on the assumption that happiness and prosperity will automatically follow. On reflection, most unhappiness in a family is found to result not from a lack of physical facility but from a lack of fulfilment in relationship. This shows that physical facility alone is not sufficient for human beings, even though it is both necessary and largely adequate for animals.

From this, it follows that three things are required for human fulfilment: physical facility, relationship, and right understanding — and none can substitute for the other. Investigating the priority among them shows that right understanding (in the self) is the first priority, since it is what allows us to correctly assess our needs and feelings. Fulfilment in relationship with other human beings, based on right feelings like trust and respect, is the second priority. Ensuring physical facility with the rest of nature is the third priority. When all three are pursued in this correct order, the outcome is mutual happiness (through right feeling in relationship) and mutual prosperity (through the right assessment and production of physical facility) — this is what is called living with human consciousness, as opposed to

animal consciousness, where physical facility is pursued alone and one ends up unhappy and deprived regardless of how much is accumulated.

Prevailing notions of happiness

Q5. Discuss the prevailing notions of happiness in society today and explain why they fail to provide continuity.

Answer:

Society commonly assumes that happiness comes from two sources. The first is the consumption of physical facility and enjoyment of favourable sensation: a physical thing contacts the body, produces a sensation, and is 'tasted' by the Self — if the taste is favourable we feel happy, if unfavourable we feel unhappy. However, this happiness is only temporary: any physical facility passes through the stages of Tasty-Necessary, Tasty-Unnecessary, Tasteless-Unnecessary and finally Intolerable. Since no sensation can remain favourable indefinitely, people keep switching from one sensation to another in a vain search for continuity, and this happiness also depends on something outside oneself, which is not guaranteed to be available.

The second prevailing notion is that happiness comes from receiving favourable feelings from others — praise, attention, respect or care. This too is only temporary and depends entirely on the other person continuing to express such feelings, which cannot be guaranteed.

In both cases, what is actually experienced is not real happiness but excitement — a short-lived, unsustainable high — which is often confused with happiness, a genuinely harmonious state within that can be continuous. Society also carries several other confused notions, such as believing happiness and unhappiness must always go together, or that one needs to be unhappy to value happiness. All these notions fail the tests of continuity and self-sufficiency, showing that real, continuous happiness cannot come from sensation or from others' feelings alone, but only from a state of inner harmony based on right understanding.

Meaning & programme of happiness/prosperity

Q6. Explain the meaning of Happiness and Prosperity according to Universal Human Values, along with the programme for their fulfilment.

Answer:

Happiness is defined as being in a state of harmony or synergy: if the state or situation in which we live is naturally acceptable to us, we experience happiness; if we are forced into a state of disharmony or contradiction, we experience unhappiness. In short, Happiness = Harmony, and Unhappiness = Disharmony.

Our living has an expanse at four levels: as an individual human being, as a member of a family, as a member of society, and as a unit in nature/existence. The programme for ensuring continuity of happiness, therefore, is to understand the harmony and live in harmony at each of these four levels — within oneself, within the family, within society, and with nature/existence.

Prosperity is defined as the feeling of having more than the required physical facility. It rests on two basic requirements: first, a right assessment of the need for physical facility and its required quantity — which comes only through right understanding; and second, ensuring the actual availability or production of more than that required quantity, which needs skills, technology and a mutually enriching production process. Without right assessment, no amount of accumulated physical facility can produce

a genuine feeling of prosperity, since the person always feels they do not have enough — a feeling of deprivation that leads to exploiting and depriving others. When a person does have a true feeling of prosperity, they naturally think of nurturing and enriching others rather than exploiting them.

Animal vs human consciousness & education-sanskar

Q7. Explain the difference between Animal Consciousness and Human Consciousness, and describe the role of Education-Sanskar in this transformation.

Answer:

Human beings can live with continuous happiness and prosperity by ensuring right understanding, fulfilment in relationship, and physical facility in the correct order of priority — this is called living with 'human consciousness.' In this state, right feeling in relationship (trust, respect) based on right understanding leads to mutual happiness, while right understanding of physical needs, combined with sustainable production, leads to mutual prosperity.

In contrast, if a person pursues physical facility alone, without right understanding and right feeling in relationships, two outcomes are possible: they make themselves and others unhappy, and because they cannot correctly identify their real needs, they never feel they have 'enough,' resulting in a continuous feeling of deprivation. This drives them to exploit and deprive others regardless of how much physical facility they actually accumulate. This is called living with 'animal consciousness' — a condition where physical facility, though necessary and largely adequate for animals, proves necessary but not adequate for human fulfilment.

The transformation from animal consciousness to human consciousness is the true goal of holistic development, and this transformation is enabled by Education-Sanskar. Education is the process of developing right understanding — a holistic perspective — in every child. Sanskar is the commitment, preparation and practice of actually living according to that right understanding, including learning the appropriate skills and technology needed to do so. Together, Education-Sanskar must ensure right understanding in the self, the capacity to live in relationship with others, and the capacity to identify and sustainably produce more than the required physical facility — enabling both individual transformation to human consciousness and, ultimately, a humane society.

Reference: Original Assignment Questions Covered Above

The five graded assignment questions (2 marks each, from UHV-II_Module_1_Assignment_10_Marks.docx) are all addressed within Section A/B above. For quick cross-reference:

Assignment Question	Covered in
Q1. Purpose of Value Education & why essential	Section A – Q2, Q3; Section B – Q1
Q2. What is Self-exploration? Role & daily-life example	Section A – Q5, Q6, Q7, Q8; Section B – Q3
Q3. Continuous happiness & prosperity as basic aspirations	Section A – Q1, Q10, Q16; Section B – Q4
Q4. Differentiate Physical Facility, Relationship, Right Understanding, Integrity	Section A – Q11, Q14; Section B – Q4, Q7
Q5. Difference between temporary excitement and real happiness	Section A – Q15; Section B – Q5, Q6

Prepared for exam/assignment practice. Since no official syllabus file was provided, coverage is based fully on the uploaded Module 1 notes, teacher's manual (Lectures 1–6) and assignment. If your teacher shares the syllabus later, this sheet can be quickly cross-checked and extended.